## Installing Stimulus

We've already installed Stimulus as part of the stimulus-rails gem install. It's worth mentioning that Stimulus depends on static class attributes, which are not a part of standard JavaScript. They are included in TypeScript, and in the default package that esbuild uses for JavaScript, so our Stimulus code will work without further configuration. If you are using other build tools like Babel, you'll need to ensure that static class attributes are allowed.

The stimulus-rails installation added some JavaScript to our code base. First off, it added a line to our application.js file:

chapter_03/01/app/javascript/application.js

```
import "@hotwired/turbo-rails"
import "./controllers"
```

By calling import "./controllers", we're assuming a module at app/javscript/controllers. The import call automatically loads an index.js file in that directory if it exists, and that's where Stimulus places the first of its two startup files:

chapter_03/01/app/javascript/controllers/index.js

```
// This file is auto-generated by ./bin/rails stimulus:manifest:update
// Run that command whenever you add a new controller or create them with
// ./bin/rails generate stimulus controllerName

import { application } from "./application";

import FavoriteToggleController from "./favorite_toggle_controller.ts";
application.register("favorite-toggle", FavoriteToggleController);
```

This file does two things: it loads a different Stimulus startup file at application.js and it loads all our individual Stimulus controllers. (Note that this has already loaded a Stimulus controller called favorite-toggle that we haven't actually described in the text yet.)

The breakdown is that the index.js file has the manifest of controllers and the